

Incidents, RCA and Postmortems

Triage, mitigation, resolution, Root Cause Analysis and learning after production issues.

Defect vs incident

A defect is an imperfection in the product. An incident is an event that degrades or interrupts a service. A defect may cause an incident, but the terms are not equivalent.

Triage and mitigation

During an incident, prioritize impact, affected users, service, timing, evidence and mitigation. Restoring user experience may come before finding root cause.

RCA — Root Cause Analysis

5 Whys, Ishikawa and evidence analysis can support investigation. Avoid ending RCA with only “human error”; look for systemic conditions that allowed the problem.

Postmortem

Document impact, timeline, cause, detection, response and preventive actions. The goal is learning and improving the system and process.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

QA tip

A good postmortem turns an incident into verifiable actions with owners and follow-up.